

SMART BICYCLES HIT THE ROAD

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Bicycles from Tour de France really get my inner-cyclist all worked up! Bicycles are becoming really handy in terms of hydraulics, light-weight, sturdiness and flexibility. But expansion of smart technology into the bikes is what has really impressed me. Bikes today can give you directions without the need of your smartphone. You can unlock your bike without any key. And in case your bike gets stolen, you can instantly track it down with your mobile. So let's explore the smart bikes that are reigning the roads today and see how smart they really are!

LeEco smart bike

To make bicycling smarter for the riders, LeEco launched Smart Road Bikes and Mountain Bikes at *Consumer Electronics Show (CES)* last year. Riders need not check their mobiles for direction while riding these two-wheelers. Neither do they need a fitbit on their wrist to check whether they have exercised enough.

The smart bike comes with a 10cm (4-inch) touchscreen docked on the frame. It runs its functions on a customised Android platform and can connect online using 4G LTE connectivity. One of the most important usage of the screen is navigation with real-time GPS tracking and optimal route calculations.

A range of sensors enable measurement and display of parameters like speed, barometric readings and direction with compass. Various details related to cycling—for example, covered distance, duration of cycling and other fitness metrics—are also calculated and stored. Another great feature of the smart bike is voice communication with other smart bikes.

All these functionalities are smoothly handled by a Snapdragon 410 processor. The bike's 6000mAh battery ensures a long running time.



LeEco smart bike with screen highlighted



Made of Toray T700 carbon fibre, the bike weighs just 8.4kg. Its 11-speed one-by drivetrain packs a punch to the cycling power.

Vanhawks Valour

Ever heard of a Wi-Fi bike? Well, Vanhawks is definitely spreading the word. Its new line of bikes, called Valour, are not just smart but connected too. Valour is haloed by sensors, chips and all kinds of gadgets.

Let us start with the navigation system. Vanhawks has created a mobile application that gives real-time information about the route being followed, upcoming directions, traffic conditions and best route suggestions. You can anchor your phone on the front while driving. If you don't want to do that—no problem! Handles on the bicycle have LED indicators. These indicators point left,